Chapter 1: Introduction

Study Guide, based on Mastering the TOGAF Standard by Eric Jager (2025), Chapter 1 (pp. 1-12)

Overview

Chapter 1 (pp. 1-12) explains why Jager wrote the book, who it is for, and how to read it. The opening pages (pp. 1-5) frame the book's core claim: the TOGAF Standard is a very applicable framework that has not been applied well, because people find it too large, too abstract, or too vague about *how* to do things (p. 2). The opening also gives a one-paragraph summary of the whole Standard: at its heart it is about establishing and implementing an **Architecture Capability**, carried out by architecture roles that use skills and competencies (p. 4). Section 1.1 answers the main criticisms of TOGAF (pp. 5-7). Section 1.2 names the two audiences, those who have and have not read the Standard (pp. 7-9). Section 1.3 introduces the four colour-coded **reading tours** (pp. 9-12). Leave with this idea: *tailoring is a must*. Not everything in the Standard has to be used (p. 5). Chapter 1 belongs to the PINK reading tour (p. 1).

> **Reading note:** This chapter is almost entirely Jager's own voice and motivation. The few statements that come from the Standard are quoted with reference numbers: the "essential scaffolding" quote (p. 5) and the note that ADM phase descriptions say *what* to do, with the *how* in the Series Guides (p. 6). Everything else, including his rebuttal of the criticisms, is his opinion.

Detailed Section Breakdown

Chapter Opener (pp. 1-5)

- **What architects can do.** Enterprise architects help organizations translate strategy into an executable whole, show the implications of that strategy, and visualize the impact of change for every level of stakeholder (p. 1).
- **Frameworks as reference works.** Architecture frameworks capture the tested knowledge of many practitioners, so architects "don't have to reinvent the proverbial wheel". They only need to follow and adapt them (pp. 1-2).
- **TOGAF's position.** The TOGAF Standard is described as the world's leading architecture framework, used by tens of thousands of architects for decades (p. 2).
- **Why the book exists.** Jager does not think TOGAF is incomplete. If anything it is "overly complete", somewhat cumbersome, and a little inconsistent. His main reason is that many architects give up on it because of the volume of information and its sometimes "fuzzy" or academic explanation (p. 2).
- **Scope of the book.** It is not a one-to-one description of the Standard. It covers the most important parts, plus extra topics and context he felt were needed (pp. 2-3).
- **Fundamental Content vs. Series Guides.** Since the 10th Edition (April 2022), the Standard is split into the durable **Fundamental Content** (the TOGAF Framework) and the faster-changing **Series Guides**, which give industry-, style-, purpose-, and problem-specific guidance. The book focuses on the Fundamental Content, plus the Series Guides that have proven essential (pp. 3-4; see Ch. 3, Sections 3.2-3.3).
- **TOGAF in a nutshell.** Establish and implement the Architecture Capability, carried out by architecture roles that use architecture skills and competencies (p. 4).
- **The work in four steps.** Understand business needs (goals and objectives); design the architecture (data, integration, technology choices); plan implementation as a flexible, iterative roadmap that

delivers value early; and govern and execute, keeping alignment with the vision while the architecture evolves (pp. 4-5).

- **Tailoring is a must.** Not everything in the Standard needs to be used in its entirety. Keeping this in mind makes the framework "a lot less overwhelming" (p. 5).

1.1 Why This Book (pp. 5-7)

- **TOGAF as de facto standard.** It is the most widely used EA framework. The Standard calls the TOGAF Framework "the essential scaffolding across industries, domains, and styles" (p. 5).
- **Three criticisms he has collected.** (1) Real examples of practical usage are missing. (2) Its prescriptions are vague, because it says the ADM should be adapted without saying how. (3) "Using TOGAF can be best explained as studying TOGAF and then doing something else instead" (p. 5).
- **His response.** The book gives practical examples from daily practice to show TOGAF's added value and to interpret the "vague" prescriptions (p. 6).
- **The criticism he accepts.** The Standard mostly describes *what*, not *how*. ADM phase descriptions recommend what may be done, and the how is left to the Series Guides, which Jager says also under-explain it. He calls this "an omission" (p. 6).
- **Aim.** To show how the Standard is used "practical and pragmatic", with powerful examples, and so debunk the "study TOGAF then do something else" quote (p. 7).

Jager's commentary (author's view): He considers most criticism of TOGAF "mostly unfounded", and he has raised the what-vs-how gap with The Open Group without it changing the framework (pp. 5, 7).

1.2 Who This Book Is For (pp. 7-9)

Audience	Their likely situation	What the book offers
Those who **have** read the Standard	Probably do not apply it daily, or think they don't, because the theory lacks meaningful examples or is too vague to apply	Practical, example-led application (p. 8)
Those who **have not** read the Standard	May be put off by the amount of theory or by negative talk about the framework	An accessible starting point that explains the theory with real-world scenarios (p. 8)

- **Breadth is necessary.** The Standard is extensive because EA's scope is broad, and every aspect must be described with little ambiguity. The book translates that theory into an accessible form (p. 8).

1.3 How to Read This Book (pp. 9-12)

- **Goal: the how, not just the what.** Each major topic is given clear steps and illustrations (p. 9).
- **Reading tours.** Besides reading cover to cover, four alternative routes exist (pp. 9-10, Figure 1-1 on p. 11):

Tour	Purpose	Chapters in this tour (from each chapter's opener)
PINK	Learn the very basics	1, 2, 3, 4, 11, 12, 22
GREEN	Learn the major concepts	3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 17, 20
BLUE	Dive into the details	5, 12, 13, 14, 16, 17, 18, 19
GOLD	Content you won't easily find elsewhere	2, 5, 6, 9, 10, 15, 17, 20, 21

- **Recommended route for newcomers.** Those who have not read the Standard should read the whole book, to see "all the ingenious relationships" between parts of the framework (p. 10).
- **Conventions.** References appear as bracketed numbers. Personal experiences use special formatting. "Further Reading" boxes point to the TOGAF Library or online resources. A steps icon marks short

step-by-step approaches. High-resolution figures can be downloaded from the author's website (p. 12).

- **Diagrams are not strict ArchiMate.** They are illustrative but use the ArchiMate colour scheme for recognizability. All names in examples are fictitious (p. 12).

Key Terms & Definitions

Term	Definition	Page
Architecture framework	A reference work describing how to map and interpret the changes an organization needs, and their impact on desired outcomes	pp. 1-2
TOGAF Framework (Fundamental Content)	The durable, stable core of the TOGAF Standard, and the focus of the book	pp. 3-4
TOGAF Series Guides	Supplementary, fast-evolving guidance (industry-, style-, purpose-, problem-specific) that is no longer a permanent part of the Framework	p. 3
Architecture Capability	What the Standard comes down to: the capability to do architecture, carried out by roles using skills and competencies	p. 4
Tailoring	Adapting the framework and using only the parts that apply to the situation. "A must"	p. 5
Reading tours	Colour-coded alternative routes through the book (PINK, GREEN, BLUE, GOLD)	pp. 9-11

Figures & Tables Referenced

Figure / Table	What it shows	Page
Figure 1-1	The alternative reading tours and the chapters each one covers	p. 11

Self-Check Questions

Q: According to Jager, what does the TOGAF Standard boil down to "in a nutshell"?

A: Establishing and implementing the Architecture Capability, which is carried out by architecture roles using architecture skills and competencies (p. 4).

Q: Into which two parts did the 10th Edition divide the Standard, and which one does the book focus on?

A: Fundamental Content (the TOGAF Framework) and the Series Guides. The book focuses on the Fundamental Content, plus the Series Guides that have proven essential (pp. 3-4).

Q: Name the four broad steps of architecture work that Jager describes in the opener.

A: Understand business needs; design the architecture; implementation planning (a flexible, iterative roadmap); and governance and execution (pp. 4-5).

Q: Which criticism of TOGAF does Jager agree with?

A: That the Standard mostly describes the *what* and not the *how*. Guidance on how is pushed into the Series Guides, and even there it is weakly articulated (p. 6).

Q: What are the three quoted criticisms of TOGAF?

A: There are no real examples of practical usage; its prescriptions are vague (adapt the ADM without saying how); and "using TOGAF" means studying it and then doing something else (p. 5).

Q: Which reading tour should you follow if you only want to brush up on the basics? And for content you won't easily find elsewhere?

A: PINK for the basics; GOLD for content not easily found elsewhere (pp. 9-10).

Q: Why are the book's diagrams not strictly ArchiMate-compliant?

A: The book explains the TOGAF Standard, not ArchiMate. The diagrams are illustrative only, though they keep the ArchiMate colour scheme for recognizability (p. 12).

Q: Why does Jager say that keeping "tailoring is a must" in mind matters?

A: Because not everything in the Standard needs to be used in its entirety. Remembering this makes the framework feel far less overwhelming (p. 5).

Q: Why are the Series Guides no longer a permanent part of the TOGAF Framework?

A: They evolve much faster than the durable Fundamental Content, so The Open Group separated them (p. 3).

Q: What reading approach does Jager recommend for people who have never read the Standard, and why?

A: Read the book cover to cover, because it reveals all the relationships between the various parts of the framework (p. 10).